Urban Alchemist

In the dense heat of New Delhi, Amit Khanna, design principal at AKDA (Amit Khanna Design Associates) proves that even a tight residential footprint can breathe. The Safdarjung Residence uses a Kahnian brick screen and an inverted-pot roof technique to create a thermal buffer against the capital's blistering sun. It also uses local Kota stone floors and a top-floor courtyard to scoop in light and air. "The most effective measures here cost almost nothing," Khanna observes. Even the humble clay brick facade, a hallmark of Kahn's palette, earns its keep. While lending the home a distinctive identity, its high thermal mass absorbs heat steadily and shields the glazing from direct solar radiation before it penetrates the glass. The result? A building that remains comfortable year-round with minimal AC, blending passive cooling with intelligent VRV systems.









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